

Checking distance helps rook defense

Endgame Technique

THE IDEA

A defending rook often needs distance from the enemy king to give repeated checks without being attacked. Checks from too close can let the king approach with tempo. The available ranks and files determine which checking method works.

WORKED EXAMPLE

If the attacking king can step toward a nearby rook while escaping check, the rook may run out of safe checking squares. From farther away, the same rook can continue checking along the rank while preserving room.

TRY IT BEFORE READING ON

What should a defender inspect before beginning side checks?

ANSWER AND REASONING

The number of files between rook and king, the king's escape direction, and whether the pawn can shield checks. Exact rook-ending rules depend on the pawn file and piece placement.

TAKE THIS INTO YOUR NEXT GAME

Give the rook enough room to keep checking safely.